Drones

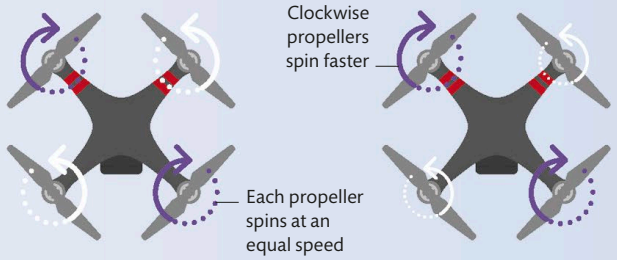
A drone is a kind of flying robot. Drones are often flown for recreation, but they also serve commercial and military purposes as well as have other important uses.

What is a drone?

A drone is an unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV). Most drones are flown by remote control, but some can be programmed to operate autonomously. To reduce weight, drones are made of lightweight materials such as plastic, composites, and aluminum. Since they are often used for photography and filming, many have a camera attached.

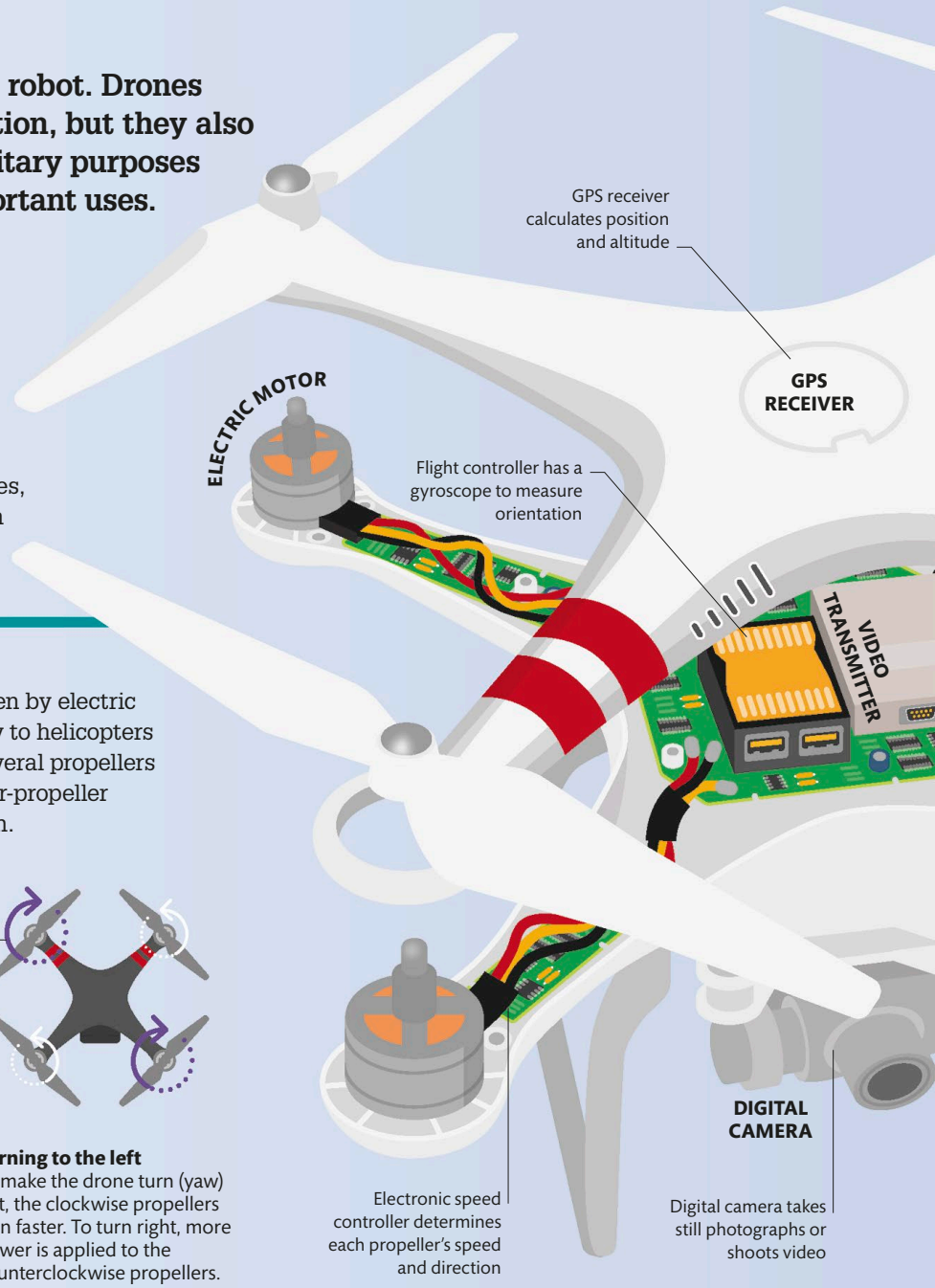
How drones fly

Drones are propelled by rotors driven by electric motors. They move in a similar way to helicopters (see pp.64–65) but usually have several propellers to produce both lift and thrust. Four-propeller "quadcopters" are the most common.



Hovering
Quadcopters have two propellers spinning clockwise and two counterclockwise. This balances their torque (turning force). To hover, all four spin at the same speed.

Turning to the left
To make the drone turn (yaw) left, the clockwise propellers spin faster. To turn right, more power is applied to the counterclockwise propellers.



Quadcopter
A quadcopter is usually equipped with a global positioning system (GPS), a flight controller, speed controllers, and a transmitter/receiver system to receive commands and send back data.

IN 2014, A **DRONE FILMED ITSELF** BEING **CAUGHT** IN MIDAIR **BY A HAWK**

